

A pretend job list to count

From marks to a morning. · Curiosity day

Name _____

Date _____



PRETEND NOTEBOOK · HEIGHT ABOVE SOIL

Day	1	2	3
Height	12 cm	19 cm	31 cm

Use the pretend notebook numbers. The picture is not a ruler.

An imagined window. The picture is enlarged to help us see.

- Job counts grow across three pretend mornings: 12, then 19, then 31. Find the change from morning 1 to 2 and from morning 2 to 3. Which change is greater, and by how much?

$$19 - 12 = \underline{\quad}; 31 - 19 = \underline{\quad}; \underline{\quad} - \underline{\quad} = \underline{\quad}$$

Show your thinking.

- One sequence uses 14 picture jobs and 9 word jobs. After that, 6 check jobs still wait. How many jobs are done before the checks? How many jobs in all?

$$14 + 9 = \underline{\quad}; \underline{\quad} + 6 = \underline{\quad}$$

Show your thinking.

- Someone says the total change from morning 1 to morning 3 is 18. Use the table to decide whether the claim is true and correct it.

$$31 - 12 = \underline{\quad}$$

Show your thinking.

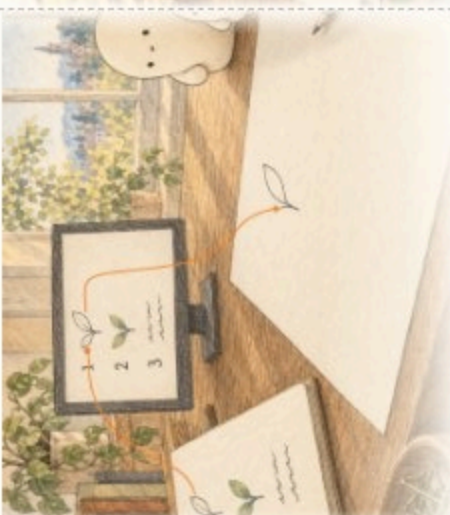
Would every real lesson need exactly these job counts? No. These numbers are invented for our math story.



Little Wonderer leans toward a soft screen. The marks are neat, not scribbles. "Are they a secret?" Big Wonderer waits. One mark alone does almost nothing. A list of marks can be instructions — tiny jobs written so a machine can follow them.



On the notebook, three jobs sit in a line: first, next, then last. That careful order is a sequence. If the last job ran first, the page would look wrong. Little copies the order with a finger. The plan lives in the sequence, not in any single mark.



A quiet helper follows job one, then job two, then job three. A line lands. A wash of color follows. A word settles into place. The blank page transforms — it changes because each instruction ran in turn. Little watches the path from list to paper.



Left: a blank page. Right: a picture and a short sentence. That difference is evidence the jobs worked. Little builds an inference: the ordered instructions made the finished page. One detail could be luck. Two matching changes are harder to ignore.

WONDER DAILY

From marks to a morning.

A story of ordered jobs



One leaf. Six steps. A story that keeps going.

GRADE 2

Make a little book.

1. Print one-sided: US letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.



Pictures are simplified and not to scale. Look closely, wonder, and pause whenever you like.

The lesson is here: words, a picture, a puzzle to try. Code became a daily morning. Little keeps one precise question: What else could a careful sequence of jobs become? Another picture? A song of clicks? The next list is waiting.



Little returns to the first screen of marks. Beside it rests a finished morning sheet — a lesson ready to use. The earlier guess ("secret scribbles") no longer fits. The marks were a plan to transform instructions into something you can learn.

Explain a tiny transform.

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Choose a scene. Write two linked sentences: one observation, then an explanation using because. Draw a detail that supports your idea.



Jobs in order



Each job runs



A page appears

Draw the detail you noticed. Add an arrow to show order or a path from job to page.

instructions · sequence · transform · evidence · inference · order · because

The order matters because ... What changes if two jobs switch places?

The page begins to change because ... Which job left the first mark you can see?

I infer that the jobs worked because ... Compare the blank page with the finished page.

Reread your words. Does the detail support your explanation? Check the first capital and each ending mark.